"Needing medication means I'm weak."

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Where it often comes from

Some grew up hearing that real strength means toughing things out. Taking medicine for pain, blood pressure, diabetes, depression, or anxiety can then feel like failure of will. Shame keeps some from starting or from being honest with their doctor.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, "It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick." Paul told Timothy to "use a little wine instead, because of your stomach and your frequent ailments" (1 Timothy 5:23). Luke, "the beloved physician," traveled with Paul (Colossians 4:14). The good Samaritan treated wounds with oil and wine. God often uses doctors and medicines as His means of care. Strength is not refusing help. Wisdom is using the gifts God provides.

> *"Jesus answered, 'It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.'"* (Luke 5:31).

Also see

> "Stop drinking only water and use a little wine instead, because of your stomach and your frequent ailments" (1 Timothy 5:23).

> "Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas send you greetings" (Colossians 4:14).

> "The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel" (Proverbs 12:15).

> "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds" (Psalm 147:3).

Common self-statements

- Strong people do not need pills.
- I should be able to handle this myself.
- Medication is a crutch.
- I am giving in.
- I have failed.
- Others manage without it.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either strong and drug-free or weak.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will depend on it forever.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ashamed and concluding that I am weak.
- Labeling: Calling myself weak.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn that needing medicine is weak?
- Would I say the same to someone with a heart condition or diabetes?
- What would my life be like without this treatment?
- What does Scripture say about doctors and remedies?

- What do I fear about taking it?
- What questions should I ask my doctor?

Truth summary

> Medicine is one of God's ways of caring for His people. Using it wisely, with my doctor's guidance, is not weakness. It is stewardship of the body God gave me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Therapy
- Weakness
- Pride
- Humility
- Wisdom

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Needing medication means I'm weak"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Needing medication means I'm weak." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn that needing medicine is weak?
- ☐ Would I say the same to someone with a heart condition or diabetes?
- ☐ What would my life be like without this treatment?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about doctors and remedies?
- ☐ What do I fear about taking it?
- ☐ What questions should I ask my doctor?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The sick need a doctor.
- ☐ God uses doctors and remedies.
- ☐ Wise people take counsel.
- ☐ Stewarding my body is wise.
- ☐ Taking medicine is not failure.
- ☐ I can ask my doctor questions.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Luke 5:31
  "Jesus answered, 'It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.'"
- ☐ 1 Timothy 5:23
  "Stop drinking only water and use a little wine instead, because of your stomach and your frequent ailments."
- ☐ Colossians 4:14
  "Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas send you greetings."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Wise care: Each week, note one way you followed through on care.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Luke 5:31 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The sick need a doctor, and there is no shame in that.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Therapy" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Write your fears. List what worries you about medication.
- [ ] Ask your doctor. Bring questions to the next visit.
- [ ] Take as prescribed. Do not stop suddenly without medical advice.
- [ ] Read Luke 5:31. Remember the sick need a doctor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Needing medication means I'm weak": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Wise care
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Needing medication means I'm weak.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, thank You for doctors and medicine. Free me from shame, and help me use these gifts wisely and faithfully. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.